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City of Fullerton, Library Technology Assistant, Supplemental Answers (as submitted 22 Oct 2026)

Please describe your highest level of completed education.

Bachelor's Degree in a related field.

This position averages 18 hours weekly; hours and days will vary to include evenings and Saturdays. Are you available to work this schedule?

Yes.

Describe your experience keeping records/statistics or preparing reports.

Record-keeping is most of what I do, and the systems that hold the records are something I have built as well as used.

In my current job as Direct Mail Production Manager at Young Americans for Liberty, I keep the organization's archive of everything it has printed and mailed to donors. When I inherited it there was no index. I designed a SQL database for the collection and defined a consistent record for every piece, covering mail code, campaign, date, format, audience and vendor, then worked back through several campaign years and cataloged the existing material against that standard. I built a searchable interface over the database so the rest of the staff can find a piece and its shelf position without going through me. I also review vendor proofs, specifications and invoices and keep the records that reconcile them.

On the reporting side, every campaign we send gets measured afterward. I track how a mailing performed against the one before it and which audiences were worth going back to, and I prepare that for senior staff so the next round is built on something more than instinct.

At the University of Austin I handled intake and documentation of the book donations the campus library was being built from. Each collection that arrived had to be received, described and recorded as a gift, and the record had to be good enough to tell a donor exactly what had come in and where it ended up. One of those gifts was a complete *Harvard Classics* set, and I followed up with that donor as the books were processed and shelved to tell them where the set had been placed.

Earlier roles were record-heavy as well. As a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law I processed and approved more than 500 exam records, transcripts and bar documents in PeopleSoft, where accuracy and confidentiality both mattered. At Young Americans for Liberty I maintained donor records for a portfolio of 320 donors across HubSpot and Salesforce, reconciled contributions with the accounting team, and tracked hundreds of conference registrations in Salesforce and shared dashboards.

Outside work I built statetrack.net, which publishes state campaign finance records for state house and state senate candidates in all fifty states. Most of that work was normalizing inconsistent records from fifty different reporting regimes into something a visitor can search.

Describe your experience providing internal and external customer service.

I have done both, and the internal side is closest to what this position actually involves.

Externally, my longest stretch of public-facing work was as a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law, where I staffed the service window as the first person students talked to. That meant answering questions in person and by phone, explaining procedures that were not obvious to somebody encountering them once, making referrals when the answer belonged to another office, and processing their records accurately. People usually arrived at that window already frustrated, and a good part of the job was patience. At Young Americans for Liberty I spent more than two years as Donor Services Director, managing a portfolio of 320 donors, answering their inquiries by phone and email, resolving account issues, and coordinating check-in and on-site logistics for conferences serving up to 1,000 attendees. At the University of Austin I led visitor tours of the campus library, helping guests of all ages locate materials and service areas and answering their questions about the collections.

Internally, I am the person colleagues come to when a system will not cooperate. I built the searchable archive our staff uses, I maintain it, I train new people on it, and I wrote the documentation that lets somebody use it without being walked through it. I also act as the main contact for our outside print vendors, reviewing specifications and proofs and holding several concurrent jobs to their dates, and I work with the accounting team to reconcile contributions against our records. As West Deputy Regional Director I supervised six state chairs across four states, met with them weekly, and trained student leaders and volunteers on the systems and procedures they needed.

That mix of staff, vendors and the public is the same mix your posting describes. The part I enjoy most is the internal half, where somebody is stuck on something and I can get them moving again.

SENT WITH TWO WORDINGS THAT DO NOT MATCH THE REST OF THE APPLICATION: this answer says "visitor tours ... guests of all ages" where the diversity answer says donor tours, and "six state chairs across four states" where the work history says Arizona, Nevada and California. If Fullerton interviews, use donor tours and three states.

If you have public library experience, please describe the length and scope of experience.

N/A. My library experience is academic rather than public: at the University of Austin, part of my development role involved the campus library, where I handled book donation intake and documentation and led visitor tours.

Describe your experience using library computer applications from a staff or patron perspective.

From the patron side I use library catalogs and subscription databases regularly, and I have begun the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification through InfoPeople, which covers library organization and procedure.

From the staff side I should be straightforward. I have not operated an integrated library system. I have not worked circulation in Koha, Sierra, Alma or anything comparable, and that is software I would be learning here.

What I can offer instead is that I have built the equivalent rather than only used one. I designed the SQL database behind my organization's archive and the searchable catalog over it, including the record structure that makes an item findable and the interface the staff search through. I did the same for the Free Knowledge Library, a digital library of political literature where I designed the classification scheme and built the catalog readers use. I have also worked daily in enterprise records systems, PeopleSoft for student records and HubSpot and Salesforce for constituent records, and I troubleshoot and train colleagues on the systems I maintain.

I expect to pick up a new system's screens quickly, because the structure underneath them is something I have built from scratch twice.

Please describe your experience working in a diverse work environment.

The settings I have worked in have all been ones where the people I served had little in common with each other beyond needing something from me.

At Chapman University's Fowler School of Law I staffed the registrar service window for the entire student body. The people who came to that window were Latino, Asian and Pacific Islander, Black and white, and a good number of them were the first in their families to attend college at all. First-generation students came to the window more often, because they had nobody at home who had already navigated a registrar's office and could tell them how it worked. Much of the job was explaining a process plainly to somebody meeting it for the first time, without making them feel they should already have known it. Part of the role was also setting up and proctoring individually proctored examinations for students with disabilities and accommodations, and keeping those records in compliance with institutional procedure.

At the University of Austin I led donor tours of the campus library. Those groups were mostly middle-aged and older, and they came from very different places, academics alongside people from business and a range of other industries, with correspondingly different reasons for being interested in the collection. I adjusted what I covered depending on who was in front of me.

At Young Americans for Liberty I supervised six state chairs across four states and trained student leaders and volunteers who arrived with very different levels of experience, and I coordinated check-in and on-site logistics for conferences serving up to 1,000 attendees from across the country.

I would add that the principle behind a project of mine is the same one behind a public library. The Free Knowledge Library is a digital library of political literature that spans the whole ideological spectrum on purpose. Collecting only the material I agree with would have been easier. But somebody trying to understand an argument needs to read it the way its own authors made it, which is the same reason a public collection serves people whose views and needs are not the librarian's.

What part of the job posting most encouraged you to apply?

That it is a technology position inside a library, and that it sits in Technical Services rather than at a public desk. That intersection is exactly where I have been trying to get to, and it does not come up often at a level I could enter.

I am tech-centric by instinct. When I run into a problem my first move is to build the system that solves it, and that is how I came to libraries rather than the other way round. I built my own library. The Free Knowledge Library is a digital library of political literature where I designed the site, the database behind it and the classification scheme, and built the catalog readers search. At work I designed the SQL database behind my organization's archive and built the searchable catalog the rest of the staff use. Doing both taught me how much I do not yet know about how real libraries solve the same problems, and I would rather learn that from people who do it professionally than keep working it out alone.

I also want to understand where this is heading. Digitization, digital collections and the way people now expect to find things are changing what a library's technology has to do, and I think that is the part of the profession that will change most over the next decade. I would rather be close to it early than catch up to it later.

The timing matters as well. I begin a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring, with a master's in library and information science to follow. Working inside a library's technical services while I study is worth a great deal more to me than fifteen hours a week suggests, because it is the practical grounding the coursework assumes you are getting somewhere. I intend to be a librarian. This is the step I want to take first.

Please describe any additional knowledge, skills, and/or abilities which you feel qualify you as a Library Technology Assistant.

A few things the other questions did not reach.

The technical work is self-taught. Nobody trained me in SQL or relational database design, and no part of my job description asked for either. I learned them because the archive needed a database and the Free Knowledge Library needed a catalog. Since then I have built and deployed two public websites, designed the schema behind both, and handled data ingestion and normalization across inconsistent sources for statetrack.net, which pulls campaign finance records from fifty different state reporting regimes. For a role where I would be learning your systems rather than arriving knowing them, the useful part of that is not the specific tools. It is that I have repeatedly picked up unfamiliar technology with nobody there to hand it to me.

I troubleshoot for other people as a matter of course, and I write things down so the same question does not come back twice. I have trained new staff on the systems I built and written the instructions that let somebody use them unaided.

I work to fixed dates with outside vendors, often several jobs running at once, where missing a date means missing a mail drop. Technical services work has a similar shape, in that the deadline usually belongs to somebody else downstream.

I am comfortable with the physical side of library work as well. I handle intake, sorting, labeling, shelving and retrieval of printed material every day, and I handled book donation intake and processing at the University of Austin.

I have also begun the ALA’s Library Support Staff Certification through InfoPeople, which covers library organization and procedure, and I begin a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring.